

UZBEKISTAN
TREK – 2027

EXPLORE
THE HIDDEN GEM
IN CENTRAL ASIA

FROM THE PREVIOUS TREKS, 2025 & 2026

- We are excited to announce the third Uzbekistan Trek, building on the incredible success of our 2025 and 2026 journeys!
- After two unforgettable editions with 95 Harvard and MIT students, we are thrilled to open the doors for a new cohort

What are the participants saying? →



"AFTER EIGHT TREKS, UZBEKISTAN WAS THE BEST ONE, BY FAR!"



"NAME SOMETHING BETTER THAN EXPLORING THE SILK ROAD GUIDED BY CLASSMATES WHO TRULY LOVE THEIR COUNTRY."



"FROM MEETING THE PRESIDENT TO DEEP POLICY CONVERSATIONS WITH MINISTERS, UZBEKISTAN SHOWED US A NATION FULL OF OPPORTUNITY AND AMBITION."



"DANCING AT ALMOST EVERY MEAL, PRIVATE ACCESS TO REGISTAN'S LIGHT SHOW, AND MEETINGS WITH NATIONAL LEADERS. TRULY ONE OF THE MOST SPECIAL WEEKS OF MY HARVARD EXPERIENCE."

MARCH 2025

The first trek. 45 travelers from Harvard and MIT, eight days across Tashkent, Bukhara, and Samarkand







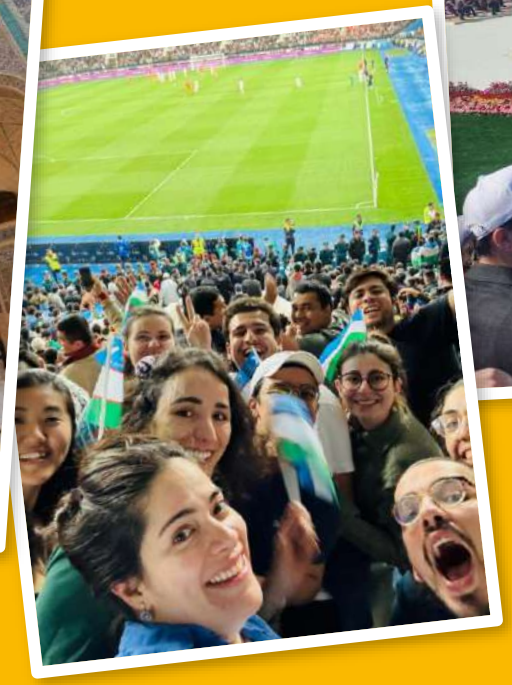
"After eight treks, Uzbekistan was the best one. By far!"

2025 participant

MARCH 2025

Nowruz with the President, Silk Road vibes, and a night at the stadium to watch Uzbekistan qualify for the FIFA World Cup









MARCH 2026

The second trek. 50 travelers from Harvard and MIT, from the Senate in Tashkent to the mountains at Amirsoy

"Name something better than being guided around the beauties of the Silk Road by classmates that truly love their country."

2026 participant







WHO THE TREKS MET

Hosts of the 2025 and 2026 treks. *The list of organizations may change for 2027.*

GOVERNMENT

- **Senate:** Chairwoman Tanzila Narbaeva
- **National Agency for Social Protection:** Shakhnoza Mirziyoyeva
- **Bukhara region:** Governor Botir Zaripov
- **Ministry of Digital Technologies:** Minister Sherzod Shermatov
- **Ministry of Higher Education, Science and Innovation:** Minister Kongratbay Sharipov
- **Central Bank:** Deputy Chairman Dr. Nodirbek Achilov

PRIVATE SECTOR AND UNIVERSITIES

- **ACWA Power:** Dr. Jon Zaidi, CEO Uzbekistan and Vice President
- **TBC Bank:** Nika Kurdiani, CEO Uzbekistan
- **IT Park**
- **New Uzbekistan University**
- **Nordic University:** Dr. Alisher Juraev

ITINERARY*

Day 1

03/14, Arrival in **Tashkent**

Highlights:

- Early check-in (if needed), Rest time
- Tashkent City Walk

Day 2

03/15, trip to **Bukhara** (fast train)

Highlights:

- Lyab-I Hauz
- Old City
- Kalyan Minaret

**Tentative itinerary*











Day 3

03/16, in **Bukhara**

Highlights:

- Arc Fortress Sitora-i-Mokhi Khosa Palace
- Mausoleum of Ismail Samani

Day 4

03/17, trip to **Samarkand** (fast train)

Highlights:

- Registan Ensemble & Shakh-i Zinda
- Bibi-Khanym Madrasah
- Registan Light Show

ITINERARY* (CONT.)











Day 5

03/18, **Samarkand - Tashkent**

Highlights:

- The Eternal City
- Ulughbek Observatory

Day 6

03/19, **in Tashkent**

Highlights:

- Meetings with government officials
- Chorsu Market

Day 7

03/20, in **Tashkent Mountains**

Highlights:

- Lake Charvak
- Amirsoy Resort

Day 8

03/21, Departures from Tashkent

Highlights:

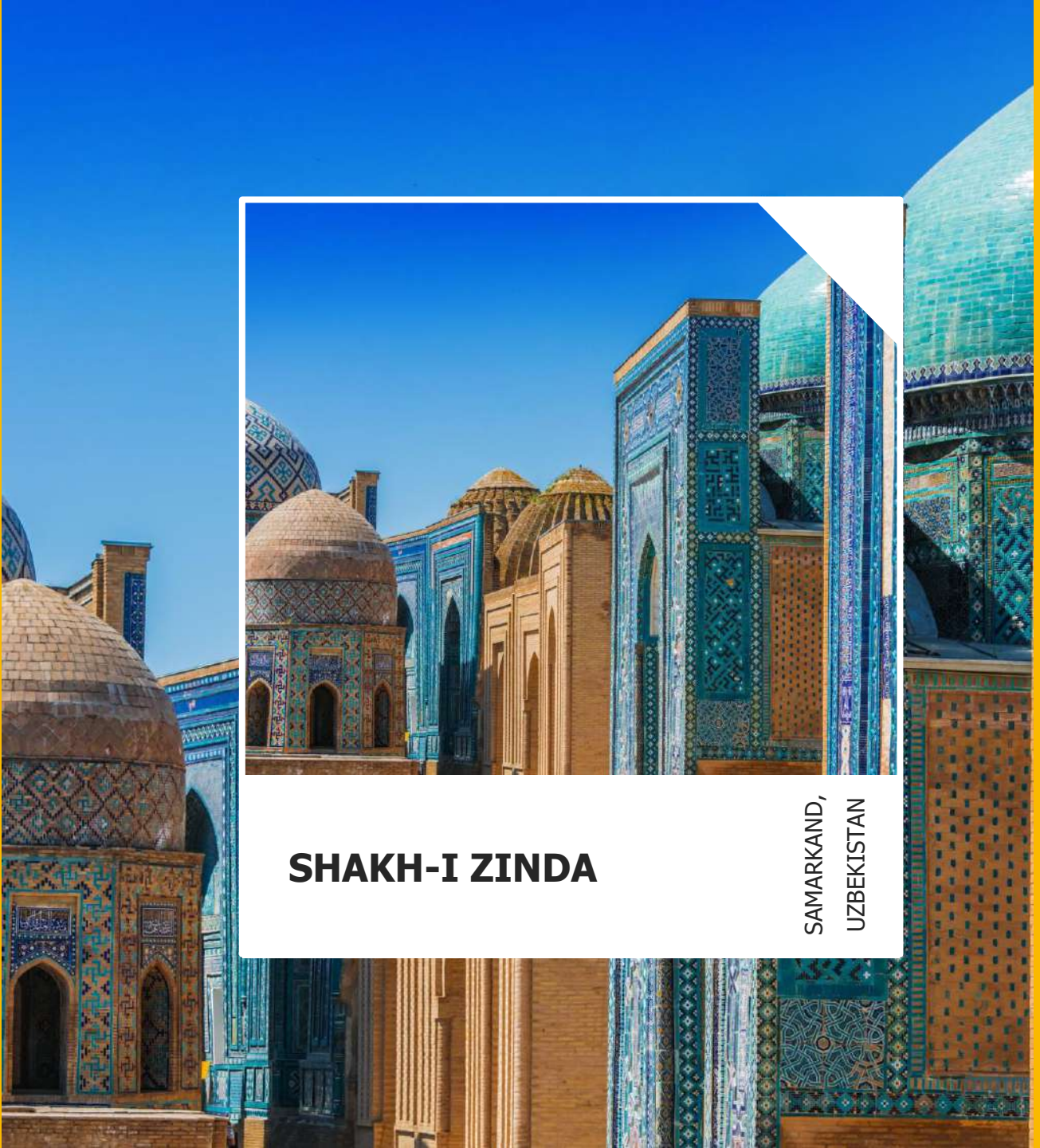
- Tashkent International Airport

**Tentative itinerary*

DATES AND COSTS

- **Trek Dates:** March 14-21, 2027
- **Cost breakdown**:
  - **[$X]** per person (double occupancy)
  - **[$X]** per person (single occupancy)
- **Payment schedule**:
  - **[$X]** deposit by **December 20**, 2026
  - **[$X]** second payment by **January 20**, 2027
  - Remaining balance by **February 20**, 2027





SHAKH-I ZINDA

SAMARKAND, UZBEKISTAN

WHAT'S INCLUDED IN COST:

- Accommodations with breakfast
- Meals (lunches and dinners)
- City tours in Tashkent, Samarkand, and Bukhara
- Cultural experiences (e.g., Nowruz celebration) with guides
- Transportation (fast trains, transfers)
- Local guide, museum entrance fees, and a SIM card

HOW TO JOIN?

- **Submit** the form here. The form is open until **December 1, 2026**, EOD.
- Make the first deposit of [$X]. The payment details will be sent to the email indicated in the application form.
- All current **Harvard** and **MIT** graduate students and postdocs are welcome! Partners of Harvard students can also apply.



FAQ:

1. What is not included in the cost?

The cost does NOT include:

- ❖ Visa fee and visa support (if required)
- ❖ International flights
- ❖ Alcohol
- ❖ Any other costs not explicitly mentioned in the program or “cost includes” section

2. Can partners join the trek?

Yes! Partners are welcome to apply. However, space is limited, and priority will be given to student applicants.

3. What are the selection criteria for the trek?

Selection will be based on:

- Interest in Uzbekistan and the Central Asian region
- Holding an advanced degree (such as a PhD or postdoc) is considered a plus
- Alignment with professional experience or personal goals
- Commitment to making the most of the trek

Students graduating in May 2027 will be given priority to help them make the most of this opportunity before they complete their studies.

4. Is there a refund if I decide to withdraw?

No, refunds are not provided once the first deposit is made due to administrative and pre-booking commitments. However, you may transfer your spot and the first deposit to another person, subject to approval by the organizers.

5. Do I need a visa to travel to Uzbekistan?
Visa requirements vary by nationality. Citizens of 90+ countries can visit Uzbekistan visa-free. Since January 1, 2026, this includes U.S. citizens, who can stay up to 30 days without a visa. Citizens of many other countries can apply online for an electronic visa at **e-visa.gov.uz**.

For official information, visit the website of the Ministry of Foreign Affairs: **https://gov.uz/en/mfa/activity_page/o-zbekiston-respublikasi-vizasi**.

We recommend searching for your country on the provided webpage to determine if there are special agreements or simplified entry options available.

6. Are international flights included?

No, international flights are not included in the trek cost. Participants are responsible for purchasing their own tickets.

> **Available Flights (non-exhaustive):**
> **Option 1:** Turkish Airlines: Boston → Istanbul → Tashkent, departure on March 13*, and Tashkent → Istanbul → Boston on March 21.
> **Option 2:** Uzbekistan Airways: Direct flight from New York → Tashkent, departure on March 14*, and Tashkent → New York on March 21 (New York-Tashkent flight may be operated by Turkish Airlines and have a layover in Istanbul)
> **Option 3:** Fly Emirates/Fly Dubai: Boston → Dubai → Tashkent, departure on March 12*, and Tashkent → Dubai → Boston on March 21.

*Arrival Details:

Please ensure you arrive in Tashkent no later than March 14th local time.
We highly recommend purchasing your tickets as early as possible to secure the best prices and ensure availability, as March is a popular travel period.

7. Who are the organizers, and who do I contact if I have questions?

The trek is organized by

- Anvar Jumaev (MPA/ID 2028)

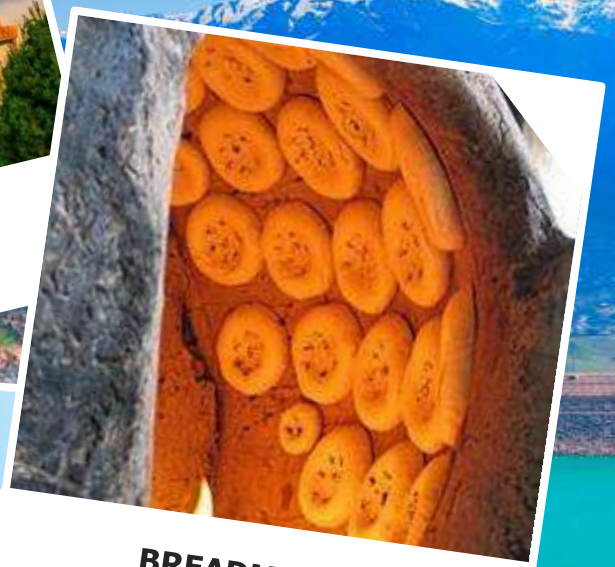
Supported by

- Jakhongir Sadiev (MPA/ID 2026)

If you have any questions, feel free to reach out to them via email.



TASHKENT



BREADMAKING PROCESS



NOWRUZ CELEBRATION

RAHMAT!

Thank you! :)